



Hot Skills

Hot Skills is a curated series designed to spotlight trending and critical skills that support career growth and future readiness. Each edition features a selection of skills accompanied by a clear rationale — framing each as a timely learning opportunity. Whether you're planning to develop in your existing career or learn a new skill, Hot Skills offers a quick, insightful way to help you stay one step ahead in your professional journey.

**In this edition: Management Essentials
Goal Setting | Managing & Motivating Teams | Building Team
Trust | Prioritization & Delegation**

01 Goal Setting

Why is goal setting the foundation of effective management?

According to Gallup, teams with clear goals are 3.6 times more likely to be engaged and productive. Goal setting provides direction, clarity, and alignment—ensuring that every team member understands what success looks like and how their work contributes to the bigger picture.

Managers who excel at goal setting can:

- Define SMART goals that align with organizational priorities
- Communicate expectations clearly and consistently
- Track progress and adjust goals as conditions change



To help you build this hot skill, explore these LinkedIn Learning courses:

- [Crafting appropriate goals](#) (3m22s)
- [Aligning goals](#) (2m57s)
- [Handling disruptions to goals](#) (2m8s)
- [Feedback systems and achieving goals](#) (2m51s)
- [Setting Team and Employee Goals Using SMART Methodology](#) (1h 5m)



Take the time to practice what you've learnt using these interactive roleplays:

- [Setting SMART Goals for a Project](#)
- [Flexible goal-setting](#)
- [Balancing short-term and long-term organizational goals](#)

02 Managing & Motivating Teams

Why is managing and motivating teams critical for performance?

According to McKinsey, motivated teams outperform peers by up to 50% in productivity and innovation. Effective management combines structure with inspiration—balancing accountability with support to unlock the best in every individual.

Managers who master this skill can:

- Create an environment of trust and psychological safety
- Recognize and celebrate achievements regularly
- Adapt leadership style to individual and team needs.



To help you build this hot skill, explore these LinkedIn Learning courses:

- [What's your team's "why"?](#) (2m42s)
- [Habits for increasing motivation](#) (2m10s)
- [Collective motivation](#) (2m52s)
- [Daniel Pink: Ask the right questions to elevate motivation](#) (5m9s)
- [How Leaders Can Motivate Others by Creating Meaning](#) (35m)
- [Leading and Managing People with Different Career Motivations](#) (1h 3m)



Take the time to practice what you've learnt using these interactive roleplays:

- [Recognizing and rewarding great work in meaningful ways](#)
- [Leading a motivational conversation](#)
- [Motivating a high performer whose performance has decreased significantly](#)

03 Building Team Trust

Why is building team trust the cornerstone of leadership?

Harvard Business Review calls trust “the currency of leadership.” Without trust, collaboration stalls and engagement drops. With trust, teams innovate, take risks, and deliver exceptional results.

Managers who prioritize trust can:

- Communicate transparently and consistently
- Model integrity and accountability in every interaction
- Empower teams with autonomy and support
- Resolve conflicts fairly and constructively



To help you build this hot skill, explore these LinkedIn Learning courses:

- [Establishing trust in leadership \(4m28s\)](#)
- [Building Team Trust as a Manager \(35m\)](#)
- [Rebuilding Trust After Failure: Team Building Strategies \(26m\)](#)
- [Leadership Accountability to Build and Maintain Trust \(32m 5s\)](#)
- [Nano Tips For Building Trust As A Leader with India Martin \(8m57s\)](#)



Take the time to practice what you’ve learnt using these interactive roleplays:

- [Being transparent to build trust with your team](#)
- [Addressing team collaboration issues](#)

04 Prioritization & Delegation

Why are prioritization and delegation essential for team success?

According to Forbes, effective delegation boosts productivity by 33% and frees leaders to focus on strategic priorities. Prioritization ensures resources are allocated where they matter most, while delegation develops team capability and confidence.

Managers who master these skills can:

- Identify high-impact tasks and allocate resources wisely
- Delegate responsibilities based on strengths and growth goals
- Avoid micromanagement while maintaining accountability



To help you build this hot skill, explore these LinkedIn Learning courses:

- [The whys and hows of delegation \(4m37s\)](#)
- [Delegate, delegate, delegate \(2m41s\)](#)
- [Follow up on delegated items \(2m58s\)](#)
- [Are you micromanaging and gate keeping? \(3m31s\)](#)
- [Prioritizing effectively as a manager under pressure \(2m49s\)](#)
- [Nano Tips for Delegating as a Manager with Lorraine K. Lee \(8m16s\)](#)
- [Delegation Strategies for People Leaders \(51m53s\)](#)



Take the time to practice what you’ve learnt using these interactive roleplays:

- [Balancing priorities under pressure](#)
- [Strategies for effective prioritization for managers](#)